



MONTOUR TRAIL COUNCIL HEADQUARTERS • 304 HICKMAN STREET • SUITE 3 • BRIDGEVILLE, PA 15017

April 21, 2009

Mr. John Quigley, Acting Director
PA Dept. of Conservation and Natural Resources
Rachel Carson State Office Building
P. O. Box 8475
Harrisburg, PA. 17105-8475

Dear Mr. Quigley;

The Montour Trail Council hereby expresses its support for the creation of a bicycle / pedestrian trail connection along the Ohio River to the area in the vicinity of the mouth of the Beaver River. Specifically, we endorse the April 2009 Beaver County Planning application to DCNR for feasibility study funding. Such a study is needed to evaluate multiple alternatives, and make recommendations for further development.

The study area begins at the present end of the Montour Trail at Allegheny County's planned recreational development of the Montour Junction site in Coraopolis. It continues downriver along the Ohio through Coraopolis, Moon, and Crescent townships in Allegheny County. Support for this project has also been expressed by Allegheny County. The corridor continues through the Beaver County communities of South Heights, Hopewell, Aliquippa, Center, and terminates in Monaca.

Beaver and Lawrence Counties have several trail projects on the ground and more in development, including westward connections into Ohio. This Ohio River trail could form the connection between that trail network and the Great Allegheny Passage trail to Washington, D.C. via the Montour. Numerous river communities would be tied in to the route, as would Allegheny County's planned large recreational facility in Coraopolis.

The Montour Trail is an important regional asset for Allegheny and Washington Counties, providing recreational, wellness, and non-motorized transportation opportunities for its residents. The 46-mile long Montour Trail mainline, as part of the planned 63-mile total Montour Trail system (including a connection with the Greater Pittsburgh International Airport), and an overall regional trail system, is also a popular destination for trail users that fosters tourism and economic development.

On behalf of our board, our over 1000 members, and our tens of thousands of trail users, I heartily endorse this important project.

Sincerely yours,

Mark Imgrund, President
Montour Trail Council